

TC004 / Top500 rank 4

Reflective Listening

Phase 5 Batch 1 v24 - full standalone TC001-grade Top500 technique package

Use it when

Best for: Emotionally loaded conversations
Clarifying disagreement
Supporting someone before advice
Professional conversations where accuracy matters
Avoid when: The person needs urgent action, not reflection
You are guessing too far beyond the evidence
Reflection would sound patronising
They have asked for a direct...

Say this

So the hard part was not just what happened, but how alone it felt. | So the main concern is the decision process, not just the outcome. | Sounds like the frustrating part was the lack of warning.

Core formula

Hear words -> identify core meaning or feeling -> reflect briefly -> pause for correction -> proceed

Avoid this failure

The main failure mode is sounding like a therapist, repeating words mechanically, or reflecting so much that the conversation stops moving.

Use to increase clarity, ease and respect - not to pressure, extract or override autonomy.

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Neighbour distinction

TC006 Emotional Labelling: TC006 names the emotion; TC004 can reflect content, feeling or concern. | TC040 Meaning Reflection: TC040 reflects significance; TC004 reflects immediate meaning or feeling.

Recovery phrase

I may be reading that wrong

Practice drill

Five-minute drill: write three real situations from the last week where this technique would have helped

Calibration cue

They say "exactly" or elaborate
They correct a small detail, which improves shared accuracy
Their tone softens
They move from defending to explaining
If the person gives shorter answers, looks tense or corrects the frame, lower intensity immediately.

Use to increase clarity, ease and respect - not to pressure, extract or override autonomy.